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Empowering The 'Hood

Young adults from non-elite areas in Delhi discover the fascinating world of computers, and transform the world within their *basti*

Preethi Chamikutty

When a non-government organisation (NGO) and a society for alternate education come together, a unique venture like the "Cybermohalla" takes form. Cybermohalla's main aims include making youngsters aged between 15 and 21 in Delhi's non-elite localities conversant with computers and helping them unleash their creativity

while documenting the daily happenings in the *basti*.

Sarai, the NGO, is a research organisation that looks at different ways that social media and emerging technology can be used to eliminate social inequality. Ankur—the society for alternatives in education—has, for the past two decades, been experimenting with various opportunities available to youngsters. Ankur works mainly in the marginalised communities of

Delhi, primarily with children, adolescents and women, and they were the ones to approach Sarai to set up Cybermohalla, a move lapped up wholeheartedly by Sarai.

The Project

The Cybermohalla project has its presence mainly in Delhi, and is now being extended to parts of Gujarat as well. Located in the Lok

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